

# 293 Make corn-husk paper

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Don't throw away your corn husks—use them instead to make paper that is just like the papyrus used by the ancient Egyptians. Ask an adult to help!



## What you need

- Corn husks • Washing soda
- Large stainless-steel pot
- Flour-and-water paste • Old dish towel • Rubber gloves
- Paper towels, newspapers



**1** Fill a pan with water, and stir in 1 tbsp washing soda per quart (liter) of water. Add the husks and simmer for 30 minutes.



**2** Wear rubber gloves. Rinse the husks in cold water. Lay them flat, and let drain on paper towels. Pat them as dry as possible.



**3** Put some husks ridge-side down, overlapping the edges. Brush with flour paste, then put more husks on top, ridge-side up, at right angles to the first.



**4** Lay an old dish towel on top, add newspaper, and weigh everything down with a heavy object until dry. Paint the paper and use it to decorate a notebook.

# 294 Grow corn

10  
MINS

Fill a container with potting soil. Sow dried corn kernels  $\frac{1}{2}$  in (1.5 cm) deep. Water regularly and leave to sprout for 7–21 days.



Corn leaves



EAR